



TAX RESOURCES

The things people call us to ask.

Deadlines, the numbers that actually changed this year, what to bring, and plain-English answers to the questions that come up every week. Free to use, whether or not you file with us.

WHAT'S NEXT

The dates that are actually coming.

Not a generic calendar starting in January — the deadlines ahead of you from today. Anything marked in gold is inside the next ninety days.

15 Sep 2026

TUESDAY

Q3 estimated tax · extended partnership and S-corp returns

Third-quarter estimate for the 2026 tax year, and the final deadline for 1065 and 1120-S returns that were extended in March.

SELF-EMPLOYED
PARTNERSHIPS
S-CORPS

15 Oct 2026

THURSDAY

Extended individual returns

Last day for 2025 Form 1040 returns filed on extension. There is no further extension — after this, late-filing penalties start accruing.

INDIVIDUALS
SOLE PROPRIETORS

Nov — Dec 2026

PLANNING WINDOW

Year-end moves

Retirement funding, equipment purchases, income and expense timing, charitable gifts, bonuses and distributions. Almost every lever closes at midnight on 31 December.

EVERYONE WITH
SOMETHING TO DECIDE

31 Dec 2026

THURSDAY

The 2026 tax year closes

Last day for most deductible actions. IRA contributions are the notable exception — those run to the filing deadline.

EVERYONE

15 Jan 2027

FRIDAY

Q4 estimated tax

Final 2026 estimate. Paying it on time is often what keeps the underpayment penalty off the return.

SELF-EMPLOYED
INVESTORS

1 Feb 2027

MONDAY

W-2 and 1099 furnishing deadline

Employers and payers must get W-2s and most 1099s to recipients and to the agencies. The statutory date is 31 January, which falls on a Sunday, so it moves to the next business day. If you pay contractors, this is your deadline, not theirs.

EMPLOYERS
ANYONE ISSUING 1099S

15 Mar 2027

MONDAY

Partnership and S-corp returns

Forms 1065 and 1120-S, or the extension to 15 September. K-1s flow from here, so a late entity return holds up every owner's personal return.

PARTNERSHIPS
S-CORPS

15 Apr 2027

THURSDAY

Individual and C-corp returns · Q1 estimate · IRA deadline

Form 1040 and Form 1120, or an extension. Also the first 2027 estimate, and the last day to make a 2026 IRA or HSA contribution.

INDIVIDUALS
C-CORPS

ON EXTENSIONS

An extension gives you more time to file, never more time to pay. If you expect to owe, the payment is still due on the original date — otherwise interest and the failure-to-pay penalty run from that day, extension or not. We estimate the payment and file the extension together.

TAX YEAR 2026

The numbers that matter this year.

Figures for the 2026 tax year — the year you are living in now, and the one your planning decisions still affect. Sourced from the IRS; we update this page when the agency does.

STANDARD DEDUCTION

Single or married filing separately	\$16,100
Married filing jointly	\$32,200
Head of household	\$24,150
Additional deduction, age 65+	\$6,000
Temporary, 2025–2028. Phases out above \$75,000 MAGI (\$150,000 joint). per eligible person	

MARGINAL RATES • TAXABLE INCOME

10%	to \$12,400
Single / married filing jointly to \$24,800	
12%	over \$12,400
over \$24,800	
22%	over \$50,400
over \$100,800	
24%	over \$105,700
over \$211,400	

32%	over \$201,775 over \$403,550
35%	over \$256,225 over \$512,450
37%	over \$640,600 over \$768,700

HEALTH & BENEFITS

HSA contribution — self-only	\$4,400
HSA contribution — family	\$8,750
HSA catch-up, age 55+	\$1,000
HDHP minimum deductible Self-only / family	\$1,700 \$3,400
HDHP out-of-pocket maximum Self-only / family	\$8,500 \$17,000
Health FSA salary reduction	\$3,400
Qualified transportation benefit	\$340 per month

RETIREMENT CONTRIBUTIONS

401(k), 403(b), 457, TSP deferral	\$24,500
Catch-up, age 50+	\$8,000
Higher catch-up, ages 60–63	\$11,250
IRA contribution	\$7,500
IRA catch-up, age 50+	\$1,100

SIMPLE plan deferral Higher limit for applicable plans: \$18,100	\$17,000
SIMPLE catch-up, 50+ / 60–63	\$4,000 \$5,250
Roth IRA phase-out Single or head of household / joint	\$153k–\$168k \$242k–\$252k
Traditional IRA deductibility If covered by a workplace plan. Single / joint.	\$81k–\$91k \$129k–\$149k

BUSINESS & MILEAGE

Standard mileage — business	72.5¢ per mile
Standard mileage — medical or moving	20.5¢ per mile
Standard mileage — charitable	14¢ per mile
State and local tax cap Phases down above roughly \$505,000 MAGI, floor \$10,000.	\$40,400

TEMPORARY DEDUCTIONS • 2025 – 2028

Qualified tips Phases out above \$150,000 (\$300,000 joint).	up to \$25,000
Qualified overtime \$25,000 joint. Same phase-out.	up to \$12,500
Car loan interest Loans originated after 31 Dec 2024. Phases out above \$100,000 (\$200,000 joint).	up to \$10,000

TRANSFERS & AMT

Annual gift tax exclusion	\$19,000 per recipient
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Estate tax basic exclusion	\$15,000,000
AMT exemption	\$90,100
Unmarried / married filing jointly	\$140,200

Figures are for tax year 2026 and come from IRS Revenue Procedure 2025-32, IRS Notice IR-2025-111, Revenue Procedure 2025-19 and the 2026 standard mileage rate announcement. Reference only — your situation decides which of these apply, and several phase out with income.

PLAIN ENGLISH

Six things worth understanding.

Written the way we would explain them on the phone, because that is where most of these questions actually get asked.

NOTICES

A CP2000 is not a bill

It is a *proposed* change — the IRS matched a form it received against your return and found a gap. You normally have 30 days to agree or disagree. A surprising share are wrong, or right about the income and wrong about the basis. Never pay one before someone reads it.

ESTIMATES

Why you owe every April

Nothing withholds tax from self-employment, investment or rental income. The fix is quarterly estimates. Pay the lesser of 90% of this year's tax or 100% of last year's — 110% if last year's AGI topped \$150,000 — and the underpayment penalty goes away.

ENTITY

When an S-corp starts to pay

The saving is on self-employment tax, and it only exists once profit comfortably exceeds a reasonable salary for your role. Below that, the payroll and filing costs eat it. The salary is not optional and not a number you pick — it has to be defensible.

RECORDS

How long to keep things

Three years is the general rule. Six if you omitted more than 25% of your gross income. Employment tax records, four. Property records until three years after you sell it. If you never filed, or filed fraudulently, there is no limit at all.

MULTI-STATE

Where you actually owe

Your resident state taxes everything; other states tax what you earned there, and your home state usually credits you for it. Remote work, a rental elsewhere, or a mid-year move each create a return most people miss — and states are getting better at noticing.

EXTENSIONS

An extension buys time to file

Not time to pay. File one and you avoid the failure-to-file penalty, which is ten times heavier than the failure-to-pay penalty. But interest and the smaller penalty still run from the original date on anything unpaid.



None of this is complicated. It's just unfamiliar, and it arrives when you're busy.

UNCLE PAT

BEFORE YOU FILE

What to have ready.

The portal gives you a checklist built for your situation.

This is the short version, so you can start gathering before you book anything.

EVERYONE

- Last year's filed return
- Photo ID and Social Security numbers for everyone on the return
- W-2s, and 1099s of every letter — NEC, MISC, INT, DIV, B, R, G, K
- 1095-A if you had marketplace health coverage
- 1098 for mortgage interest, 1098-T for tuition, 1098-E for student loan interest
- Bank routing and account number for the refund or payment

SELF-EMPLOYED AND BUSINESS OWNERS

- Profit and loss and balance sheet, or the bookkeeping file
- Bank and credit card statements for every business account
- Mileage log, or total business and total miles for the year
- Home office square footage and total home square footage
- Asset purchases over \$2,500 with dates and amounts
- Payroll reports and copies of 1099s you issued

- Any IRS or state letters received since your last filing
- K-1s from any partnership or S-corp you hold
- Estimated tax payments made, with dates

OFFICIAL TOOLS

Straight to the source.

Everything here is a government site. We link to them rather than reproducing them, because these are the versions that stay current — and because nobody should take a tax figure from a marketing page without being able to check it.

Where's My Refund

Refund status, updated daily. Available about 24 hours after an e-filed return is accepted.

irs.gov/refunds

IRS Online Account

Your balance, payment history, notices and transcripts in one place. Worth setting up before you need it.

irs.gov/payments/online-account

Get Transcript

Wage and income transcripts — what the IRS was actually told about you. The first thing we pull on any back-year matter.

irs.gov/individuals/get-transcript

IRS Direct Pay

Pay a balance or an estimate straight from a bank account, no fee. Keep the confirmation number.

irs.gov/payments/direct-pay

Withholding Estimator

Check whether your W-4 is set right. Or let us do it — the Withholding Checkup is free.

irs.gov/individuals/tax-withholding-estimator

Identity Protection PIN

A six-digit code that stops anyone else filing a return under your Social Security number.

irs.gov/identity-theft-fraud-scams

Comptroller of Maryland

Maryland returns, payments, notices and business tax accounts.

marylandtaxes.gov

Virginia Department of Taxation

Virginia individual and business filing, payments and correspondence.

tax.virginia.gov

Filing in another state? We work all fifty — ask and we'll point you at the right agency, or just handle it.

WHAT THIS PAGE IS AND ISN'T

General information, current as of September 2026, not advice about your situation. Tax figures change every year and most of them phase out with income. Before you act on anything here, let us look at your actual numbers — the consultation is free.